
FULL CHAPTER REVIEW REPORT

CHAPTER: The Corporate Stage: Algorithmic Surveillance, Hybrid Visibility, and the Paradox of Spectatorship in the Modern Workplace
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General

Is the work original and important to the field?

Yes

Does it have the appropriate research work structure?

Yes

Has academic vocabulary been used?

Yes

Are the sections complete and in a logical order?

No

Chapter Title

Is the title easy to understand and does it convey the important aspects of the research?

Yes

Originality

iThenticate Report Findings: 0%

Is the chapter acceptable in its current form?

Yes

Is the work original? (It was not already published?)

Yes

Does it give proper attribution?

Yes

Abstract

Does the abstract summarise the article?

Yes

Does it include key findings?

Yes

Introduction

Does it introduce and put into perspective what follows?

Yes

Methodology

Are the research methods and analysis well explained?

No

Suggestions for improvement

As this is a perspective-oriented chapter rather than an empirical study, several of the methodology-related questions below are not directly applicable. However, the conceptual process through which the proposed framework is developed would benefit from clearer explanation and justification. In particular, the author should explain more explicitly the rationale for integrating Goffman, Foucault, and Zuboff, the criteria by which their respective concepts are combined, and how this synthesis leads to the distinct constructs of “corporate stage,” “hybrid visibility,” and “paradox of spectatorship.”

Can peers reproduce the experiments and get the same outcomes?

No

Did the authors include proper references to previously published methodology?

No

Is the description of new methodology accurate?

No

Could or should the authors have included supplementary material?

No

Key Results

Is discussion carried out in satisfactory matter?

No

Suggestions for improvement

The Discussion contains potentially valuable implications, particularly the conceptualization of opacity as an organizational resource. However, these implications require further development and stronger engagement with contemporary workplace research. The discussion should connect the proposed framework more explicitly to relevant scholarship on employee monitoring, algorithmic management, autonomy, trust, wellbeing, and psychological safety, and clarify its implications for organizational and management practice.

Does the conclusion support the presented research?

Yes

References, Tables and Figures

Did the authors include proper references to previously published literature cited in the work?

No

Suggestions for improvement

The reference base should be substantially strengthened. In particular, the chapter would benefit from greater engagement with contemporary research on workplace surveillance, electronic performance monitoring, algorithmic management, employee autonomy, trust, wellbeing, and related organizational outcomes. The author's earlier publication developing the concept of "paradox of spectatorship" should also be acknowledged and cited, with the relationship between the earlier formulation and its present application clearly explained.

Comment on figures, tables and schemes (their relevance/irrelevance)?

Yes

Suggestions for improvement

The chapter would benefit considerably from a conceptual figure presenting the proposed theoretical framework. In particular, a visual representation could clarify how the perspectives drawn from Goffman, Foucault, and Zuboff are integrated and how "corporate stage," "hybrid visibility," and the "paradox of spectatorship" relate to one another and to their proposed organizational implications. Such a figure would make the chapter's conceptual contribution more transparent and easier to evaluate.

Type of Publication

Which type of publication is this chapter?

Perspective chapter

Comments for Authors

Dear Author,

Thank you for submitting this intellectually ambitious and interdisciplinary chapter. The manuscript addresses a highly relevant aspect of the contemporary workplace by examining how hybrid work and algorithmic monitoring reshape the relationship between visibility, performance, and self-observation. The proposed synthesis of Goffman, Foucault, and Zuboff is potentially valuable, and the concepts of the corporate stage, hybrid visibility, and the paradox of spectatorship provide an interesting basis for developing a distinctive theoretical contribution.

The chapter is clearly written and contains several thought-provoking ideas. However, in its current form, the conceptual contribution requires further clarification and stronger positioning within contemporary workplace scholarship. Several claims and illustrative cases also need stronger evidentiary support, while some material currently included in the manuscript is insufficiently connected to its central argument. I therefore recommend Major Revisions and encourage the author to address the following points:

1. Clarify and strengthen the conceptual framework and its contribution

The integration of Goffman, Foucault, and Zuboff is central to the chapter, but the logic through which these perspectives are combined should be explained more systematically. In its current form, the manuscript introduces corporate stage, hybrid visibility, and paradox of spectatorship as closely related concepts, but their respective conceptual boundaries are not always sufficiently clear. Please define each construct more precisely, explain how the three concepts relate to one another, and what explanatory function each performs. It would also be useful to explain more explicitly why these three theoretical traditions are particularly appropriate for the proposed synthesis and what becomes analytically visible through their combination that could not be adequately explained through the existing perspectives separately. A conceptual figure would be particularly helpful here. Such a figure could visually represent the integration of Goffman, Foucault, and Zuboff and clarify the relationships among corporate stage, hybrid visibility, paradox of spectatorship, and their proposed organizational implications.

2. Clarify the relationship with the author's earlier use of the concept "paradox of spectatorship"

The author has previously used the concept "paradox of spectatorship" in the published article "Why Then Should I Require an Audience": The Dynamism and a Paradox of Spectatorship in the Peach Blossom Fan (2025). Since the present manuscript again places the paradox of spectatorship at the center of its conceptual contribution, the relationship between the earlier use of the concept and its present application to algorithmically monitored work should be explicitly acknowledged and clarified. Please cite the earlier publication and explain whether the present conceptualization represents an extension, reformulation, transfer of the concept to a new domain, or a distinct theoretical development. This clarification would strengthen the manuscript by making the intellectual genealogy of the concept transparent and by allowing readers to identify more precisely what is new in its application to the contemporary workplace.

3. Engage substantially more with contemporary workplace scholarship

The chapter draws on an interesting interdisciplinary range of theoretical and historical sources. However, its engagement with contemporary research directly addressing the workplace phenomena under discussion remains comparatively limited. For a chapter concerned specifically with the modern workplace, the theoretical argument should be situated more firmly within current scholarship on areas such as electronic performance monitoring, workplace surveillance, algorithmic

management, digital or datafied work, employee privacy and autonomy, trust, wellbeing, psychological safety, and related organizational outcomes. Of course, this does not require transforming the chapter into a systematic literature review. Rather, the relevant literature should be used selectively to establish what is already known, demonstrate the gap addressed by the proposed framework, and show more convincingly what the corporate stage and paradox of spectatorship add to existing explanations of digitally mediated workplace visibility.

4. Provide stronger support for empirical claims and illustrative cases

Although the chapter is appropriately presented as a theoretical/perspective contribution rather than an empirical study, a number of statements describe contemporary workplace practices and employee experiences in relatively general terms without sufficient supporting evidence. This is particularly relevant to the three illustrative settings discussed in Section 4.2: remote productivity software, call-center monitoring, and gig-platform rating systems. These are useful examples, but their evidentiary status should be more clear. Where they describe actual workplace practices and consequences, the discussion should be supported with appropriate empirical research. Alternatively, if they are intended primarily as conceptual illustrations of the proposed framework, this should be stated explicitly. More generally, please distinguish carefully between empirical evidence concerning contemporary monitoring practices, theoretical interpretation of those practices, and propositions derived from the framework developed in the chapter.

5. Develop the organizational implications more substantially

The idea developed in the Discussion that opacity may function as a scarce organizational resource is potentially one of the most interesting implications of your chapter. However, the transition from the critical-theoretical analysis to organizational recommendations currently requires further development. Please explain more fully what treating opacity as a legitimate organizational design constraint would mean in practice and connect this discussion to relevant research on autonomy, privacy, trust, wellbeing, psychological safety, monitoring practices, and organizational design. The chapter would benefit from distinguishing more clearly between the theoretical implications of the framework and recommendations that can reasonably be made for managers or organizations on the basis of existing evidence.

6. Improve the focus and integration of interdisciplinary material

The chapter's interdisciplinary breadth is potentially a strength, and the historical and cultural examples can help demonstrate that self-presentation under an evaluative gaze long predates algorithmic monitoring. However, some of these excursions are relatively extensive in comparison with the treatment of contemporary workplace research. Thus, I encourage the author to review these sections with a view to retaining those historical and cultural examples that directly advance the central argument while shortening or removing material whose connection to the workplace framework is primarily analogical. The additional space could then be used to strengthen engagement with the contemporary literature most directly relevant to the chapter's subject. The sections labelled "Civil-Rights Framing" and "Bridge to Law" should also be reconsidered and integrated more organically into the chapter. In their current form, they read somewhat as standalone additions rather than fully integrated components of the argument. If the regulatory dimension is retained, its relationship to the theoretical framework should be made explicit and developed consistently.

7. Please remove material unrelated to the chapter

The appendix "Empire Under the Night Sky — HoST Dossier Citations", including the standalone discussion of fenye and Qing cosmography, should be removed from this chapter. The manuscript itself explicitly states that this material is "unrelated to this chapter's argument" and that nothing in the appendix bears on the chapter's discussion of algorithmic surveillance, hybrid visibility, or the paradox of spectatorship. Material explicitly unrelated to the chapter's argument should not form part of the submitted manuscript. Its removal would considerably improve the coherence and professional presentation of the chapter.

8. Review and strengthen the reference base

Finally, please conduct a careful review of the reference base. In addition to acknowledging the author's earlier work on the paradox of spectatorship, important claims concerning contemporary workplace monitoring and its consequences should be supported by appropriate scholarly sources. Literary, historical, cultural, and legal materials can certainly remain where they perform a clear conceptual or illustrative function, but they should complement rather than substitute for the research literature directly addressing the workplace phenomena analyzed in the chapter.

I believe the manuscript contains an interesting and potentially distinctive conceptual idea, and its interdisciplinary perspective could make a valuable contribution to the volume, but the chapter would benefit substantially from a clearer conceptual architecture, stronger engagement with contemporary workplace scholarship, more careful evidentiary grounding, and a tighter focus on material that directly advances its central argument. I encourage the author to preserve the chapter's originality and interdisciplinary character while developing it more fully as a contribution to the study of the contemporary workplace.

Good luck with your work.

Review Results

Major revision (second review required)